Contact

sidshot07@gmail.com

www.linkedin.com/in/sidhhesh-s (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Marketing Strategy

YouTube Video Creation

YouTube Analytics

Certifications

Microsoft Azure AI Machine Learning

Sidhhesh Shirsath

Building brands from ZERO to Three times. | Brand & Marketing @STAN | Ex. Sportskeeda | Growing audiences organically | Gaming × Creators × Culture | Connecting Brand Through Content #

India

Summary

I build audiences from zero and grow them fast. Organic first. Content that makes you stop scrolling. Paid only when it's ready to scale. It started in 2019. Esports events ran 6-7 hours and nobody was covering them in real time. I saw the gap and built a page that did — Gamingup. Zero spend. 30,000 followers in six months. Sold it. That instinct — spot the gap, move early, build what people actually want; has driven everything since. At Sportskeeda, I turned a general gaming page into an esports-first media platform. Reach grew 12x (1M → 12M). Followers went from 147K to 324K in 14 months. No performance budget behind it — just sharper positioning, daily updates delivered fast, and content built for trust, value, and recall. At STAN, I joined when there was no social presence. Built Instagram from 0 to 100K+, Twitter from 0 to 26K, monthly reach to 7M+. Then led STANFest 2024 — India's largest creator meetup. 400M+ impressions. 30K footfall. Alongside this, I ran STAN's creator partnerships vertical — 40+ brand campaigns across Mixi, Zupee, Harley Davidson, boAt, Instamart, and more. I work across the full marketing stack: brand strategy, GTM, content, performance campaigns (Meta, Google UAC), creator partnerships, and on-ground activations. I know how to grow organically when budgets are tight and how to use paid smartly when it's time to scale. I've worked with brands, agencies, and platforms across gaming, entertainment, and consumer tech — and I'm comfortable across all three. Capturing numbers through content with a pinch of relatability and creativity. Looking for the next team that wants to build something real in gaming, creator economy, or culture. sidshot07@gmail.com

Experience

STAN

Branding & Marketing Manager

May 2022 - Present (4 years)

Joined as an early-stage hire, transitioned to full time.

- Built STAN's social presence from zero — grew Instagram to 100K+, Twitter to 26.8K, and monthly reach to 7M+ organically.
- Led STANFest 2024 end-to-end — India's largest creator meetup, delivering 30K footfall, 400M+ impressions, and 100M+ content views with 200+ creators including Ashish Chanchlani, MortaL, and Fukra Insaan.
- Conceptualized and produced STAN ke Sitaare — a creator documentary series strengthening STAN's creator-first positioning.
- Managed 200+ creator partnerships end-to-end and led STAN's creator agency vertical across 40+ brand campaigns with Zupee, Harley Davidson, boAt, and Instamart.
- Launched Minecraft, Roblox, and Anime categories from 0 to 1 — onboarded 300+ creators and created campaigns with 10-20 day retention funnels.
- Led STAN's PR strategy — earned coverage from Google's AI Fund and a public mention from Sundar Pichai.
- Led GTM for STAN Photon (Web3 launch) — acquired 3,000+ new onchain wallets and grew Twitter by 2K in the launch window.
- Managed a 8-member content and social team across strategy, execution, and reporting.

Sportskeeda

3 years 2 months

Content Producer

October 2023 - June 2025 (1 year 9 months)

Transitioned to part-time as I moved full-time to STAN.

- Led both YouTube and Instagram teams — established data-driven growth strategies that scaled monthly revenue 30x through format optimisation and audience-first content planning.
- Led YouTube growth strategy organically — added 120K+ subscribers in 12 months through evergreen, topic-led content.
- Drove 120K+ new YouTube subscribers in 12 months through evergreen, topic-led content with strong search intent.
- Built GameOnAir — an original interview-led content IP that crossed 10M+ views across 10 episodes.
- Partnered with Sales on client closures and with the Business team on quarterly revenue roadmaps — aligning content output with commercial targets.

Social Media Manager
August 2022 - October 2023 (1 year 3 months)

Repositioned Sportskeeda from a general gaming page into an esports-first media platform through a data-driven content and audience strategy.
- Scaled esports Instagram from 147K to 324K (+115%) and monthly reach from 1M to 12M (+900%) in 14 months — purely organic.
- Launched "Pick Your Best" — an interactive community voting format that drove 10K+ follower growth in 5 days with participation from Mortal, Scout, Jonathan, and Goldy.
- Established original content IPs with strong brand recall — SK Recommends, Guess Who, and daily news formats creating a repeatable content framework for the team.
- Led relationships with major gaming publishers (Krafton, Riot Games, Red Bull, Garena) as the PR point of contact and led on-ground coverage for BGIS, BMPS, and TEC Valorant.

Assistant social media manager
May 2022 - August 2022 (4 months)

- Structured Sportskeeda's esports content engine in partnership with external agencies — streamlined the daily production flow and set the foundation for the organic growth phase that followed.
- Built cross-promotion systems across Instagram, YouTube, and Twitter to maximise reach on every piece of content produced.

FULL STOP Media
Marketing Consultant (Independent)
January 2021 - May 2024 (3 years 5 months)

Delivered brand strategy, social growth, and content direction for 20+ clients across gaming, esports, and entertainment — including Wings Lifestyle, Individual Content creators and Upthrust Esports.
- Built 0→1 brand identity and GTM for BattleBucks — directed the brand video (800K+ paid views), grew - Instagram from 0 to 10K in 30 days, and acquired 50K+ pre-launch users.
- Led content and PR for Bigg Boss contestant Arun Mahashetty and Playground finalist Chill Gamer — scaled combined following to 800K+.

GemWire
Consultant
May 2021 - March 2022 (11 months)

India Today Gaming
Social Media Executive
November 2021 - January 2022 (3 months)
India

Developed and executed comprehensive social media strategy for India Today Gaming's esports events division.

Campaign: World Esports Cup (Tri-Nation Free Fire Tournament)
→ Led event coverage strategy across Instagram, Twitter, YouTube
→ Delivered 1M+ impressions during campaign window
→ Acquired 20K+ new followers
→ Managed daily content execution and creator engagement

Responsibilities:
- Social media planning and execution for esports tournaments
- Content strategy for multi-platform distribution
- Event coverage coordination with tournament organizers
- Community engagement and audience growth

Megastars Esport
Social Media Manager
January 2020 - June 2020 (6 months)

GamingUP
Founder
February 2019 - May 2020 (1 year 4 months)

Founded one of India's first esports-focused community pages.
- Spotted the gap: esports events ran 6-7 hours. Audiences had no real-time coverage.
- Built a page that delivered live scores, updates, and highlights.
- Grew 0 → 30,000 followers in 6 months. Zero paid spend.
- Built foundational relationships across Indian gaming here.
- Successfully sold the property to a gaming company.

— Today —

Rebuilding the property with an expanded scope — Instagram + YouTube. Reactivating the 26K+ dormant audience into a monetisable media brand.

Education

Vishwakarma Institute Of Technology

Bachelor's degree, Engineering · (June 2020 - July 2024)

Modern College of Science

· (June 2016 - June 2018)